

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

ries of spending and we went through each category, item by item. Sure enough, they couldn't live on \$15,000. So I asked them to read some materials on budgeting and come back in about a week.

In all honesty, I didn't really know what to tell them because most of their spending went toward housing, automobiles, and food, and it looked as if they didn't make enough.

A little later, another couple came in. I asked the husband, "What do you think the problem is?" He replied, "We don't make but \$25,000 a year and I don't see any way we can live on that."

So I got out another budget sheet and we went through every category of spending. As you might guess, there was no way their budget would make it on \$25,000.

After lunch, a third couple came in for counsel. I repeated my earlier question, to which the husband responded, "We don't make enough money. We only make \$75,000 a year."

Using my trusty budget sheet, I quickly verified that indeed they could not live on \$75,000.

If I could have taken the \$75,000 income from the third couple and given it to either of the first two couples, they would have thought they were wealthy. But I also realized that within a very few years they would have been back in for counseling, unable to live on \$75,000.

More money is not the answer; more discipline is. Until couples decide to live on what they already make, more money will not help. As Solomon said, "He who loves money will not be satisfied with money, nor he who loves abundance with its income. This too is vanity" (Ecclesiastes 5:10).

I think of a pastor I met with the village missions ministry. He had never made more than \$12,000 a year in his entire life, and only that much in the latter part of his career. He was approaching retirement and he asked if we could talk about a financial problem.

His "problem"? He had \$600,000 in investments and had no idea of what to do with it. When I asked how he had accumulated so much, he told me he had invested in small tracts of